

Philip Nordquist

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SUMMARY

Platform and security engineer, previously Staff Operations Engineer at ExpressVPN. I've set the technical direction and built the platform hosting all of STIM's production applications, led releases across 3,000+ VPN servers, and shipped countermeasures to keep services reachable in censored regions. I stay close to the implementation, using AI agents and automation throughout my daily work.

EXPERIENCE

DevSecOps Engineer

Nov 2023 – Present

STIM, Stockholm, SE

- Architected and built STIM's Kubernetes platform on VMware, now hosting all production applications. Automated provisioning with Terraform and Ansible, cutting new-cluster setup from days to about 15 minutes.
- Established GitOps with Argo CD across the platform's clusters, standardising deployment and configuration management for shared platform services.
- Designed the platform so nodes and clusters can be rebuilt from code, with persistent application data backed up separately.
- Established security monitoring and incident response in Microsoft Sentinel across Entra ID, Intune and Microsoft 365. Carry out forensic investigations and contain incidents as part of the security on-call rotation.
- Automated server patching with Azure Arc, cutting about 100 hours a year of after-hours maintenance.
- Expanded 1Password from IT credential storage to application secrets management across the organisation.

Staff Operations Engineer

Apr 2021 – Jul 2023

ExpressVPN, Hong Kong / Remote

- Led operational readiness for the global ExpressVPN Keys launch, defining the support model and a cross-region failover design with a recovery target under 15 minutes.
- Reverse-engineered how adversarial networks fingerprinted and blocked VPN traffic, then shipped protocol-level countermeasures (proxy protocols, packet obfuscation) keeping the service reachable in heavily censored regions.
- Built the Prometheus/Grafana monitoring stack for 3,000+ servers and the global proxy fleet.
- Enabled the global service desk to resolve more VPN connectivity issues through playbooks and technical training, reducing engineering escalations.
- Led weekly releases across 3,000+ VPN servers with canary deploys, sustaining 99.9% uptime.
- Co-designed the Operations interview loop and conducted 50+ technical interviews on production engineering scenarios.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Senior Cloud & Infrastructure Engineer

Apr 2019 – Apr 2021

ExpressVPN, Hong Kong

- Led corporate network design and rollout across global offices, using Palo Alto firewalls and zero-trust controls to reduce lateral-movement risk.
- Automated IAM via Okta across 200+ SaaS apps, cutting user provisioning from 3 hours to 15 minutes.
- Delivered secure remote-work infrastructure for 1,000+ staff during COVID with zero downtime.

IT Infrastructure & Operations Manager

Sep 2017 – Apr 2019

Universum Communications AB, Stockholm, SE

- Led IT operations for the Stockholm headquarters (100–200 staff) and offices across Europe, Asia and North America.
- Led technical due diligence and a G Suite to Office 365 migration during M&A; implemented technical and data governance controls to support GDPR readiness.

IT Engineer

Sep 2015 – Sep 2017

ExternIT, Stockholm, SE

- Promoted internally from Binero (same group). Managed Windows/Linux servers and Cisco/HP networks for MSP clients; improved reliability through monitoring and automation.

Support Engineer

Oct 2014 – Sep 2015

Binero AB, Stockholm, SE

- Provided L1/L2 support for Linux web hosting, DNS, and email, including escalations.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Platform:	AWS, GCP, Azure, VMware vSphere; Kubernetes (K3s, EKS, GKE); Terraform, Ansible, Argo CD/GitOps, Helm.
Security:	Microsoft Sentinel, detection engineering, incident response; zero trust, OIDC/SAML/RBAC, CIS/NIST hardening, PKI.
Networking:	VLANs, routing, firewall policy, DNS, BGP; VPN/proxy architectures, traffic analysis.
Observability:	Datadog, OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, SLOs.
Code & Automation:	Python, Go, Bash, GitHub Actions; Azure Arc, cert-manager, 1Password.
AI & Agents:	Agent workflows, MCP tool integrations, prompt design, human-in-the-loop automation; OpenAI, Anthropic and Gemini APIs.

SIDE PROJECTS

- Built an MCP server connecting AI agents to Interactive Brokers for portfolio research, with audit logging and human approval controls.
- Built LLM assistants for Telegram and Slack, covering API integrations, backend and frontend; evaluated model cost, latency and reliability across OpenAI, Anthropic and Gemini.

EDUCATION

Högskolan i Skövde

2011 – 2014

Computer Game Development, coursework

Linköpings Universitet

2008 – 2011

Communication, Media & Society, coursework

LANGUAGES

Swedish (native), English (fluent)